Then the younger of Taṃbal's cadet brothers, Sulṭān Muḥammad Galpuk, was in Andijān. Babur along with his party took the mulberry road. By the time of midday prayer, they had reached Khākān (canal), south of the town. A foraging party was sent. Babur followed it along Khākān to the skirt of 'Aīsh-hill. The scouts brought the message for Babur. According to them, Sulṭān Muḥammad Galpuk had ventured out with whatever number of men he had, beyond the suburbs to the skirt of 'Aīsh. Babur didn't want to miss the chance. He hurried to meet him, although the foragers were still scattered. Galpuk perhaps had more than 500 men, and despite having more men in totality most of them on Babur's side were scattered as foragers.

When the two came face to face, it appeared that both sides had a similar number of men. Without showing much care about the order or array of the formation, they galloped on horses, losing rein. As they got near, Galpuk's men could not stand the fight. The swords were crossed but for no glory to the enemies of Babur. Babur's men chased them almost till the Khākān Gate, unhorsing one after another. By the evening prayer, Babur's men had out-mastered the Galpuk's troops, reaching Khwāja Kitta, on the outskirts of the suburbs.

Babur was very clear with his ideas. He wanted to go quickly right up to the gate but Qaṃbar-'alī Beg and Dost Beg's father, Nāṣir Beg, with their experience, said, 'It is almost night; it would be ill-judged to go in a body into the fort in the dark; let us withdraw a little and dismount. What can they do tomorrow but surrender the place?'

Babur, respecting the advice of the two experienced begs decided to retire to the outskirts of the suburbs. However, he regretted paying heed to their advice. In the *Baburnama* he has written, 'If we had gone to the Gate, undoubtedly, Andijān would have come into our hands.'

Taṃbal Shocks Babur

By the time Babur and his men crossed the Khākān canal, the sun had disappeared completely. They dismounted around nighttime prayers near the village of Rabāṭ-i-Zauraq. Babur knew that Taṃbal had broken from his camp and was on the way to Andijān. In this context, Babur has called out the opinion of his two experienced begs as negligent and inexperienced. Babur has said that by further showing inexperience, they dismounted on